

Common Q&A – ICN Victoria App Development

Company Profiles and Information Management

Q: Can companies create and edit their own profiles in the app?

A: No, company profiles are managed by ICN Victoria (the client).

Q: Will company owners have freedom to choose what they display?

A: No. Initially, company information will be derived from ICN Victoria's capability data research and will include basics like company name, ABN, address, sectors, items, and capability. Further company details may be sent to ICN Victoria by a company representative for update.

Q: Can companies communicate with each other in the app?

A: The platform is not designed for company-to-company chatting. It provides company information so users can reach out directly. A chat feature may be included only for contacting ICN Victoria Customer Services, but this is not a requirement.

Q: Should certificates or company achievements be included?

A: While not required, certifications such as Kinaway certified, Made in Australia certified, or Fair Trade certified are desirable.

Accessibility and Audience

Q: Who can access the app – only certain audience or the general public?

A: General public.

Q: Should corporate culture be highlighted?

A: No, apart from indicators such as female-owned, FN-owned, or certifications mentioned above.

Q: Is the goal to attract collaborators, staff, or both?

A: The goal is to attract collaborators from Victorian industry and government agencies, and to promote ICN Victoria's sector research capabilities.

Q: Should salary information or vacancies be included?

A: No, the focus is on sectors, capabilities, and items associated with organisations.

Q: Do you want to display company ratings?

A: No, ratings would make the app similar to Hi-Pages and go against providing fair information.

Q: Should there be a trending page to showcase popular companies?

A: No, this would unfairly promote some companies over others.

Search and Filtering

Q: What search and filtering options should be available?

A: At a minimum:

- Capability types*
- Sectors*
- Location filter (radius/distance/within X km)*
- Ability to search components/items*

Other desirable filters: company size, certifications, demographic-focused filters (female-owned, FN-owned), revenue, etc.

Q: What does filtering by capability type entail?

A: It shows where along the supply chain a company sits. Multiple capability types will be defined and selectable (e.g. tick boxes). For example, someone searching for a manufacturer of air conditioners would not need results for companies that only service or install them.

Q: Should demographic-focused filters be included?

A: Preferable. These should be worded as female-owned, FN-owned, etc.

Q: How can users express interest in specific company attributes?

A: A tick-box or icon filter option (e.g. select "female-owned" or "FN-owned") would suffice, though design is up to you.

Q: What company capabilities should be highlighted?

A: All capability types provided in the dataset.

Backend and Data Handling

Q: Can organisations have multiple capability types?

A: Yes. For example, a company may supply, install, and service air conditioners. A capability type can be served by multiple companies. (Many-to-many relationship)

Q: Can organisations be based in multiple locations?

A: An organisation may have multiple locations, but the app will only include one primary address in the dataset.

Q: The client's dataset shows 'supplier' rather than specific sub-types (raw material, parts, etc). Should we refine this?

A: No. "Supplier" is sufficient for now.

Q: The organisation names are missing from the dataset. Is this intentional?

A: Yes, this is intentional to protect private company information. You may use artificial names for presentation purposes if needed.

Q: Should sector be attributed to items or organisations?

A: Sector should be attributed to items. Items are attributed to organisations.

Free vs Premium Features and Monetisation

Q: What functions should be free and what should be premium?

A: To be confirmed. A dedicated document will be provided by ICN Victoria.

Q: How should premium features be showcased compared to free ones?

A: Options include tiered subscriptions, greyed-out pages, pop-ups or banners, or blurred/hidden text that links to an upgrade page.

Q: How can we balance free and premium features?

A: The app must remain functional for free users. More detailed or private information can be paywalled, or results can be limited.

Q: What profit model is preferred?

A: A long-term subscription model (monthly or yearly). One-time payments are not preferred.

Q: How should premium features be advertised?

A: Depends on the feature. Large hidden features may warrant full-screen pop-ups. Smaller features (like a hidden company attribute) could use banners or blurring.

Presentation and Design

Q: How should these elements be presented (text, images, icons)?

A: Creative design is up to you. Icons are preferred but should be explained or supplemented with text.

Q: Should a company's official website be linked?

A: Yes. The company website should be shown alongside contact information.